

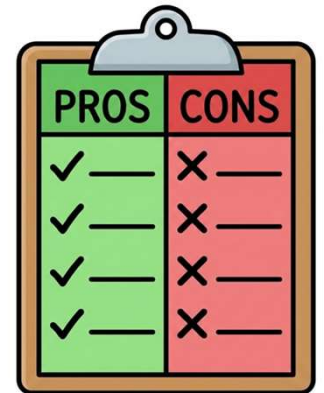
# Procurement Strategy

Group 8

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## Decision Framework | Multi-Criteria Decision Analysis (MCDA)

- MCDA is a structured decision making framework used to evaluate and rank multiple decisions based on specific criteria.
- Core Components:
  - Decision alternatives: Options being evaluated
  - Criteria: Factors used to assess alternatives
  - Weights: Relative importance assigned to each criterion
  - Stakeholders: Decision-makers whose preferences guide the evaluation
- Process:
  1. Define the decision and alternatives
  2. Select evaluation criteria
  3. Rate each alternative
  4. Assign weights to criteria
  5. Sum up scores to determine best alternative



## MCDA Matrix | Streamlined Reporting

### Decision Outcome

- Streamlined Reporting selected as the digital transformation initiative
- Highest MCDA score: **3.8**

### Why it matters?

- Reporting inefficiencies were identified as a major operational bottleneck.
- Manual data consolidation slowed decision-making.
- Digital reporting platforms enable real-time insights and enterprise data governance.

*Streamlined reporting scored highest due to strong strategic value, scalability, and manageable implementation difficulty.*

**Scale:** 1 = Very Low | 2 = Low | 3 = Moderate | 4 = High | 5 = Very High

| Criteria                         | Weights  | Land Acquisition | Timesheet Enhancement | Streamlined Reporting |
|----------------------------------|----------|------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| <i>Risk Reduction</i>            | 0.10     | 4                | 4                     | 3                     |
| <i>Strategic Value</i>           | 0.30     | 3                | 2                     | 5                     |
| <i>Operational Efficiency</i>    | 0.20     | 4                | 4                     | 3                     |
| <i>Implementation Difficulty</i> | 0.15     | 5                | 3                     | 5                     |
| <i>Scalability</i>               | 0.10     | 5                | 5                     | 5                     |
| <i>Cultural Readiness</i>        | 0.15     | 1                | 1                     | 1                     |
| <b>Totals</b>                    | <b>1</b> | <b>3.5</b>       | <b>2.9</b>            | <b>3.8</b>            |

*Total = Score X Weight*

## Procurement | Evaluation Criteria

Scale: 1 = Poor Fit | 2 = Weak Fit | 3 = Moderate Fit | 4 = Good Fit | 5 = Strong Fit

- Strategic alignment weighted highest due to need to support total enterprise data strategy
- Security and Scalability are prioritized due to growing data footprint
- Cost is on the lower end because long term capability matters more than short-term savings

| Criteria                                 | Weight (%) | Why it Matters                                                                                                                           |
|------------------------------------------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Strategic Alignment</i>               | 20         | <i>Ensures the technology investment directly supports specific business goals rather than being a standalone IT project</i>             |
| <i>Security &amp; Compliance</i>         | 15         | <i>Protects the organization from data breaches, legal liabilities, and ensures adherence to industry-specific regulations.</i>          |
| <i>Scalability</i>                       | 15         | <i>Ensures the system can handle future growth in users and data volume without requiring a complete architectural overhaul.</i>         |
| <i>Integration with existing systems</i> | 10         | <i>Determines how easily the new solution communicates with existing systems to eliminate manual data silos.</i>                         |
| <i>User Experience</i>                   | 10         | <i>Directly impacts the adoption rate; if a tool is difficult to use, employees will revert to old, inefficient manual processes.</i>    |
| <i>Implementation Timeline</i>           | 10         | <i>Determines how quickly the business can expect a return on its capital and labour investment.</i>                                     |
| <i>Customization Flexibility</i>         | 5          | <i>Allows the solution to be tailored to unique, proprietary business logic that standard "out-of-the-box" tools cannot handle.</i>      |
| <i>Vendor Stability/ Reputation</i>      | 5          | <i>Mitigates long-term risk by ensuring the provider will continue to support, update, and secure the platform for years to come</i>     |
| <i>Change Management</i>                 | 5          | <i>Identifies the level of training (and cultural shift) required to ensure the workforce successfully transitions to the new system</i> |
| <i>Total Cost of Ownership (TCO)</i>     | 5          | <i>Provides a view of both up front costs and long-term operating expenses to ensure sustainable profitability.</i>                      |

# Market Options

1. Microsoft Fabric
  - A unified data platform for enterprise analytics
2. Databricks
  - An advanced data engineering and AI platform
3. Amazon AWS
  - A scalable cloud data infrastructure
4. SAP Crystal Reports
  - An enterprise reporting tool for structured reports





**Microsoft Fabric**

# Microsoft Fabric | Background & Market Presence

## Overview

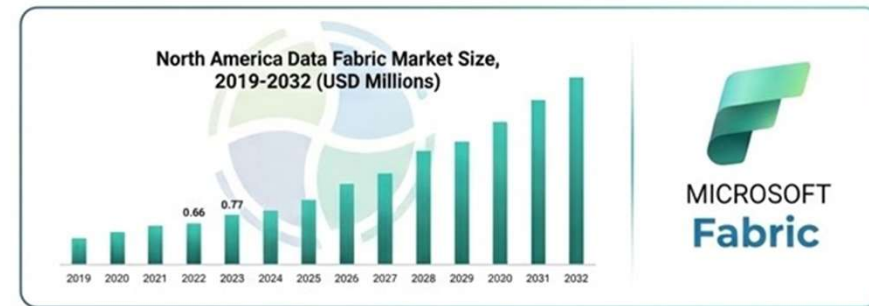
- Microsoft is a global technology leader that provides a comprehensive ecosystem of AI-powered productivity software, cloud infrastructure, and unified data platforms.
- Microsoft Fabric serves digital transformation as a "complete data platform" that brings together several data-related workloads under a single architecture.

## Industry Specialization

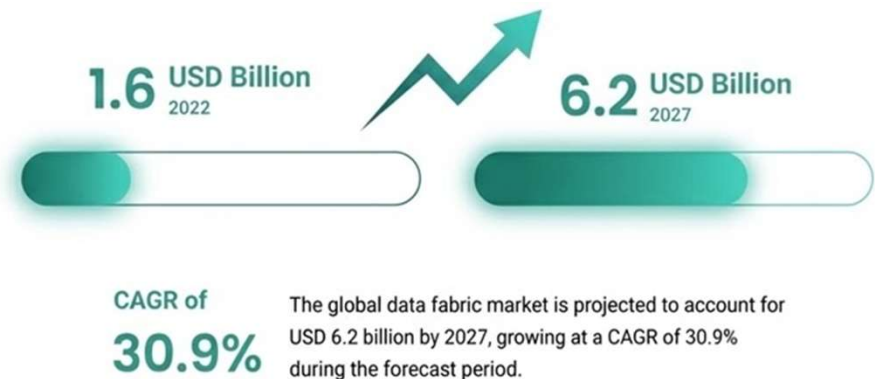
- The platform is already being utilized across diverse sectors.

## Market Presence

- Fabric is positioned as a "next generation" platform that provides a mission-critical infrastructure for global organizations.

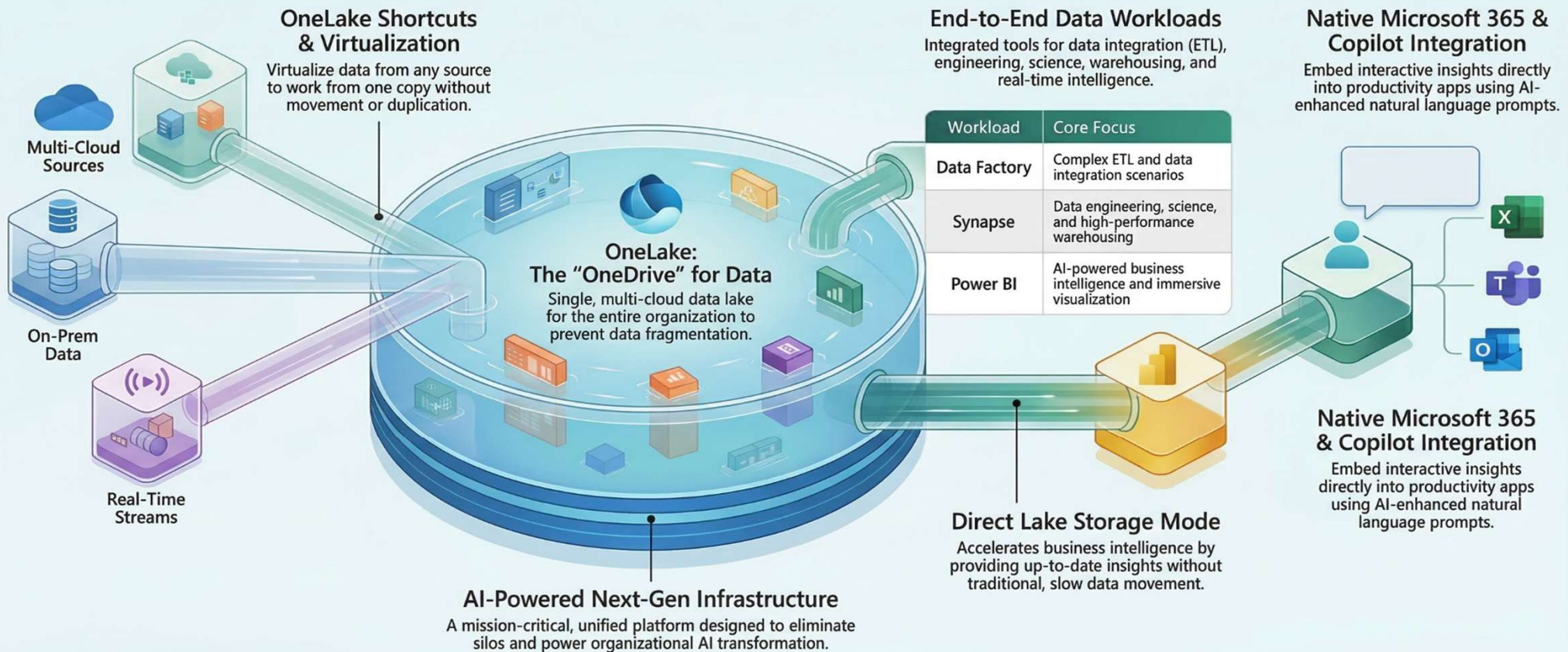


Data Fabric Market Overview





# Microsoft Fabric: The Unified AI-Powered Data Ecosystem





# Microsoft Fabric | Background & Market Presence

## Cost Structure

- Organizations use a tiered price plan based on user needs, starting at F2 \$399.53 CAD and incentivized for term commitments with ~41% saving.



## Strengths

- Current Users of Microsoft 365
- Consolidate multiple data tools into one
- Reduce Data Prep and refresh issues
- Governed Enterprise reporting
- Open Ecosystem
- Focus on Creating a "Data Culture"



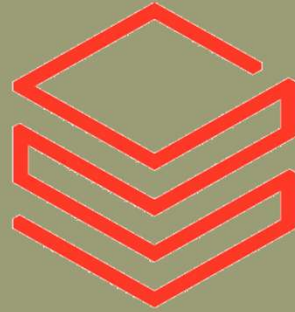
## Demo / Trial Observations

- A free trial is available where users receive a fixed amount of capacity

## Risks

- Capacity Estimator for costs
- Steep Learning Curve for small orgs
- Some technical training needed

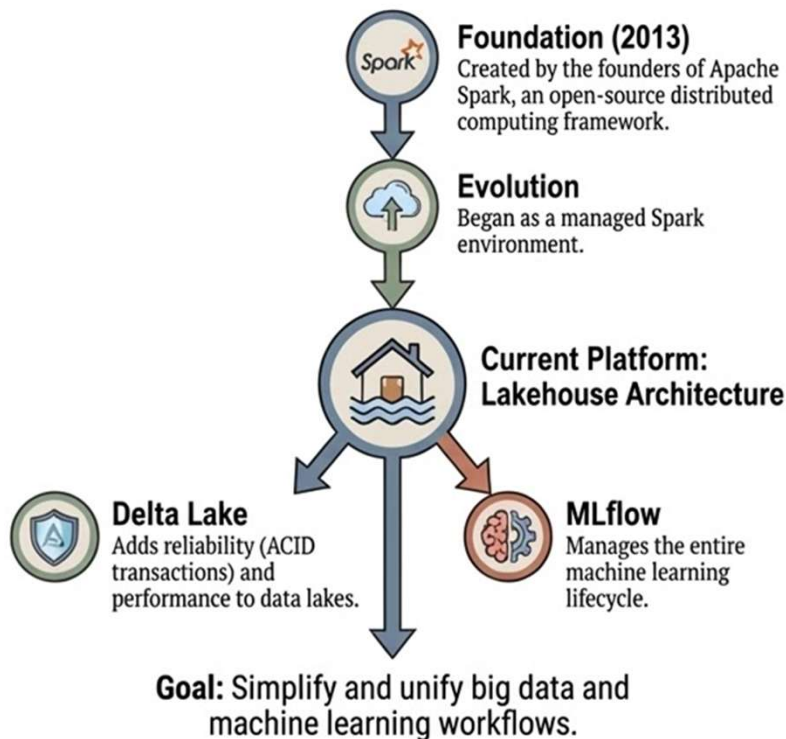




**databricks**

## Databricks | Background & Market Presence

### Background



### Market Presence



**> \$5.4**

**Revenue Run-Rate:** > \$5.4 Billion USD



**> 65%**

**Growth:** > 65% Year-over-Year



**> 20,000**

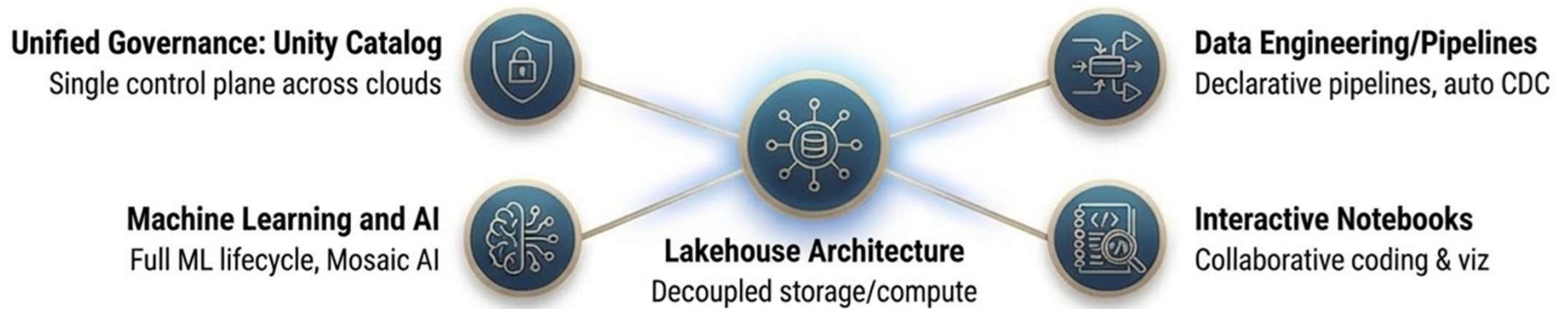
**Customers:** > 20,000 organizations (including > 60% of the Fortune 500).



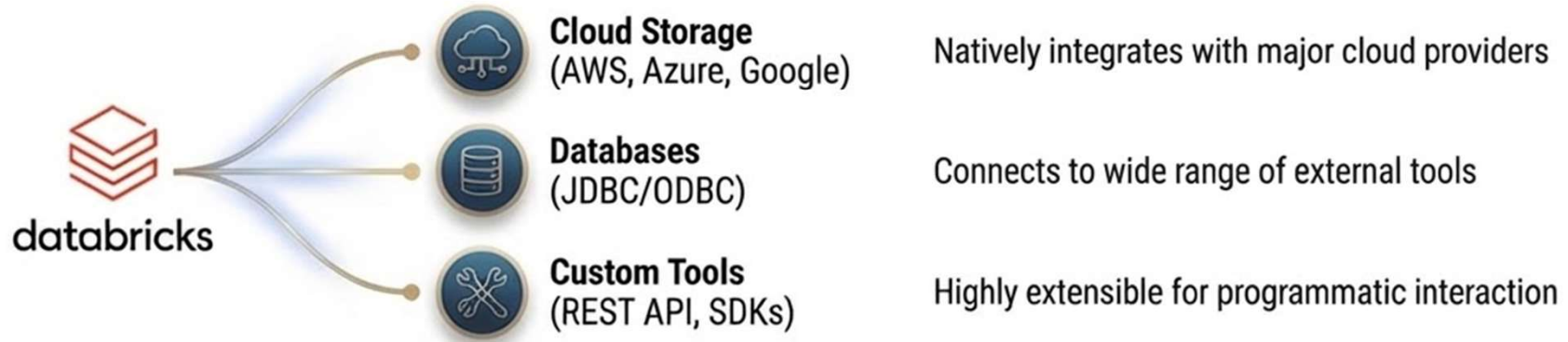
**Competition**

**Competition:** Competes with platforms like Snowflake and Microsoft Fabric.

## Databricks | Core Capabilities and Competitive Edge



### Differentiators (AI-Native, Open, Automated): Integration





# Databricks | Unified Platform & Cost Structure Overview

## Unified Data & AI Platform Advantages



### Unified Data & AI Platform

Integrates data engineering, data science, and AI into a single collaborative environment, eliminating silos and accelerating time-to-insight.



### Optimized Performance & Reliability

Enhanced Databricks Runtime for faster processing than standard Spark, with standard Spark with Delta Lake ensuring data flow, ensuring consistency and quality.



### Multi-Cloud Versatility

Provides a consistent consistent experience across AWS, Azure, GCP) in deep native service integration.



### Extensive Open Ecosystem

Seamlessly integrates with popular third-party tools (e.g. BI (e.g. Tableau), orchestration (orchestration (e.g.. TensorFlow, and ML TensorFlow).

## Cost Structure & Pricing (DBU Model)



**Data Engineering**  
\$0.15/DBU



**Data Warehousing**  
\$0.22/DBU



**Interactive Workloads**  
\$0.40/DBU



**Artificial Intelligence**  
\$0.07/DBU

## Factors Influencing Total Cost



**Regional Variations:** The price per DBU and the underlying cloud.



**Committed Use Contracts:** Organization can access discount benefits to specific usage levels.

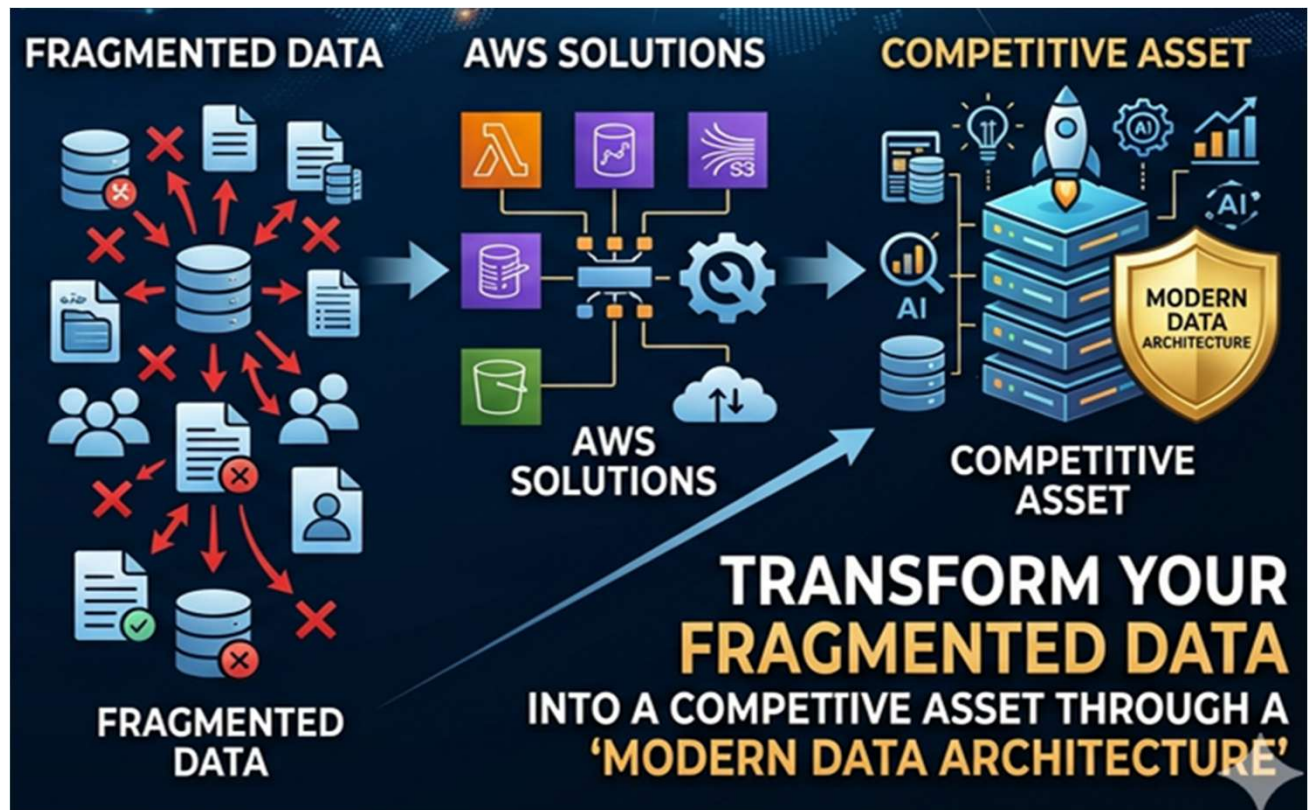


**Infrastructure Costs:** DBU pricing software the Databricks provider for compute, storage, and networking.



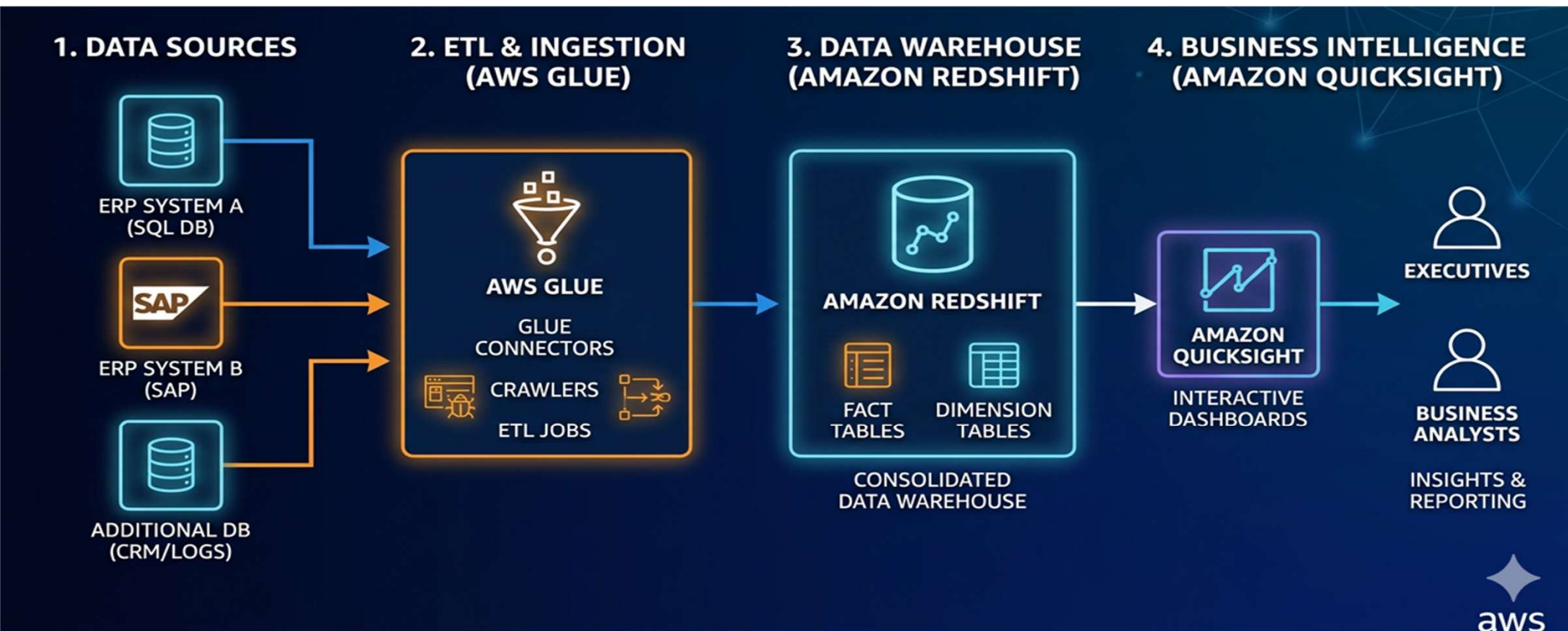
## Amazon AWS | Overview and Vendor Stability

- Trusted by 80% of Fortune 500 companies
- Global Leader in Cloud Infrastructure
- Over 33% of market share in 2025





## Amazon AWS | Product & Service Overview (The “Tech Stack”)



## Amazon AWS | Additional Information



### CUSTOMIZATION & INTEGRATION

- Connectivity to various databases.
- API-driven event refreshes.
- Hurdle: Technical mapping between distinct data models.
- Customization and Integration Challenges.



### COST STRUCTURE

- Standard pay-as-you-go billing model.
- Specific costs for ETL (Extract, Transform, Load) implementation.
- Potential Hidden Costs: Data egress fees.
- Ongoing maintenance.



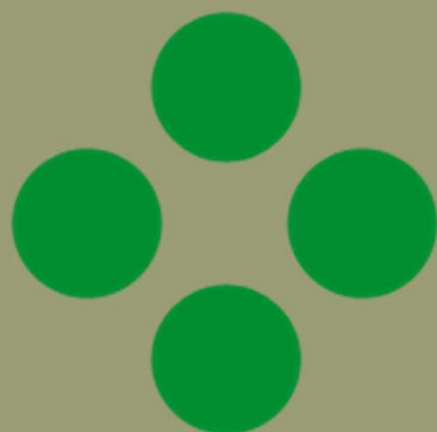
### STRENGTHS & RISKS

- High level of technological maturity.
- Robust security infrastructure.
- Vendor considerations: Vendor lock-in.
- Technology & Vendor analysis.



### USER EXPERIENCE (UX)

- Modern management interfaces.
- Natural Language Query (NLQ) capabilities for data discovery.
- Interactive dashboards & Canned reports.
- Designed for UX analysis.



crystal reports

## SAP Crystal Reports | Company & Product Overview

### **VENDOR: SAP**

- ▶ Founded 1972 — Germany
- ▶ Largest enterprise software providers globally
- ▶ Known for ERP, analytics & BI solutions

**400K+**  
Organizations

**1972**  
Est. Year

### **PRODUCT OVERVIEW**

- ▶ Enterprise reporting tool for structured business reports
- ▶ Connects to ERP systems and SQL databases
- ▶ Converts raw data into formatted reports & insights

### **CORE CAPABILITIES**

 **SQL Querying**

 **Custom Reports**

 **Data Visualization**

 **Scheduled Reports**

 **Export: PDF, Excel & More**

## SAP Crystal Reports | Integration, Customization & Cost

### INTEGRATION — Compatible Data Sources



ERP Databases



Cloud Warehouses



SQL Server / Oracle



Excel & Flat Files

**Methods:** ODBC/JDBC connections • .NET & Java APIs • SAP BusinessObjects Platform



### CUSTOMIZATION

- ▶ Build SQL queries to extract ERP datasets
- ▶ Custom reports for Accounting & Property Mgmt
- ▶ Define KPIs & standardized report templates
- ▶ Role-based access control for users



### COST STRUCTURE

**\$495**

per user license

- ▶ Implementation & config
- ▶ ERP integration
- ▶ Ongoing support

**⚠ Hidden Costs:** Consulting fees, infrastructure upgrades & training



## SAP Crystal Reports | Strengths, Risks & Trial Experience

### ✓ STRENGTHS

-  **Highly Customizable**
-  **Strong SQL & DB Connectivity**
-  **Enterprise Financial Reporting**
-  **Mature & Widely Adopted**

### ⚠ RISKS

-  **Vendor Lock-In**
-  **Licensing Complexity**
-  **Needs Technical Expertise**

### TRIAL

**30-Day**  
Free Trial Available

#### PROS (User Reviews)

- ✓ Powerful report formatting tools
- ✓ Strong SQL query capabilities
- ✓ Supports multiple enterprise DBs

#### CONS (User Reviews)

- ✗ Interface may feel outdated
- ✗ Steep learning curve for beginners

## Final Recommendation | Microsoft Fabric

### Why It's the Best Fit

- Strong alignment with reporting and analytics goals
- Works well with existing Microsoft tools and scalable for growth
- One unified platform reduces the need for multiple reporting tools reducing long-term costs

### Key Considerations

- Pricing may increase as usage grows
- Staff may need training to use the platform effectively

Scale: 1 = Poor Fit | 2 = Weak Fit | 3 = Moderate Fit | 4 = Good Fit | 5 = Strong Fit

| Criteria                                 | Weights (%) | Microsoft Fabric | Databricks  | AWS         | SAP Crystal |
|------------------------------------------|-------------|------------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|
| <i>Strategic Alignment</i>               | 20          | 5                | 4           | 5           | 3           |
| <i>Security &amp; Compliance</i>         | 15          | 5                | 4           | 5           | 3           |
| <i>Scalability</i>                       | 15          | 5                | 5           | 5           | 3           |
| <i>Integration with existing systems</i> | 10          | 5                | 4           | 4           | 2           |
| <i>User Experience</i>                   | 10          | 4                | 3           | 4           | 3           |
| <i>Implementation Timeline</i>           | 10          | 4                | 3           | 3           | 5           |
| <i>Customization Flexibility</i>         | 5           | 3                | 4           | 5           | 2           |
| <i>Vendor Stability/ Reputation</i>      | 5           | 5                | 4           | 5           | 5           |
| <i>Change Management</i>                 | 5           | 4                | 3           | 3           | 5           |
| <i>Total Cost of Ownership (TCO)</i>     | 5           | 4                | 3           | 4           | 5           |
| <b>Total</b>                             | <b>100%</b> | <b>4.6</b>       | <b>3.85</b> | <b>4.45</b> | <b>3.35</b> |